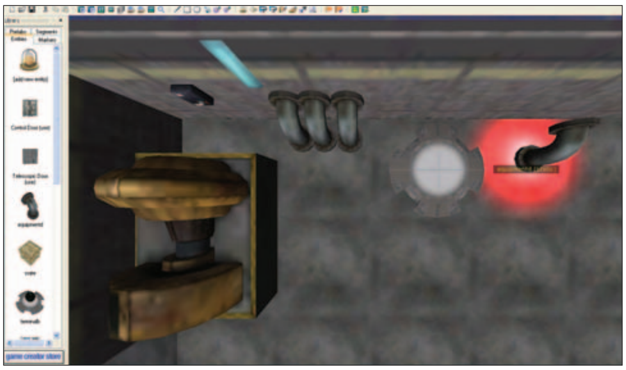
**3 years**
The average development cycle of a game

**Profits?**
Only the top 5% leading games manage to rake in money

From our levels, notice that there are rooms and corridors on different levels. The laws of physics don't apply, so you don't have to consider objects such as pillars. Just make sure nothing is disconnected from the rest of the segments. While you're creating the map itself, make plenty of nooks and corners to hide enemies, areas where you can pick up ammo and health.

Now it's time to decorate the map and add touches. There are lights available, switches for lights, windows, furniture and and other items. There are a range of these like pipes, corpses and crates, so strew them liberally around the map. This adds colour and character to the game.

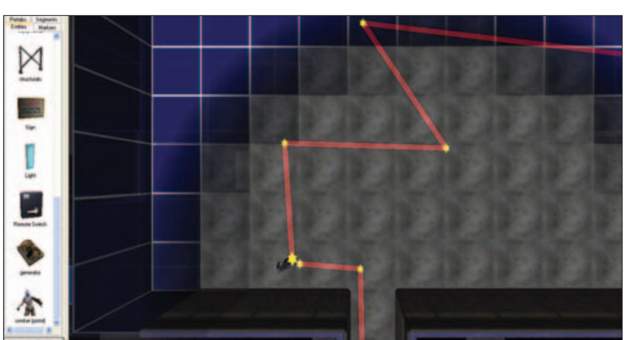


**Placing stuff**

It is a good idea to zoom in while placing things around the map. Some of these objects are really small, and placing them correctly takes a lot of time. Skip this if you don't have the time. Create the environments, which makes the experience much better when you actually play the game.

Next, go to `Entities > Sci-Fi > characters`, and select enemies. Place them around the map too. Use armed environments for better results. Place them around corners or behind doors to make the game interesting.

Once you have placed an enemy, you can waypoint it so that it patrols an area. By default, the waypoint mode is enabled. Press `[W]` and click Near the enemy. A star would now appear. All enemies will catch on to and follow the nearest waypoint. So you can make a particular enemy follow complicated routes through the map, and even across levels if you want. Hold `[Shift]` and click on the star again, and you should get a stretchable bar that you can drag around. Place the second star at a point where you want the enemy to go to. Repeat the process till you have set paths for your enemies.

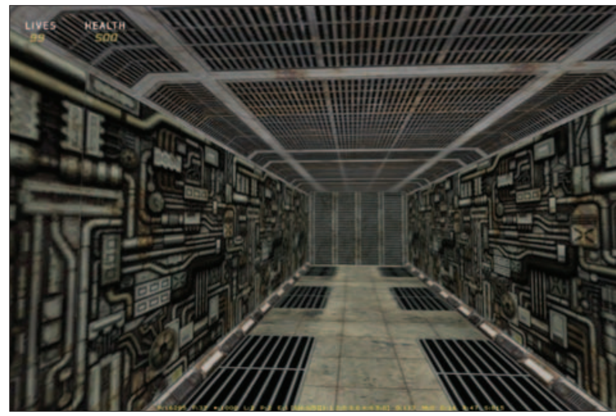


**Way points**

Now, go to `Entities > Sci-Fi > Items` and select Weapons and ammunition. Liberally scatter these around the map. Markers are a way of telling the software what you want the game to do at particular points and at particular times. You can create "hurt" and "heal" zones, set the start and end points of the game, as well as program complex triggers that take particular actions when the player comes there. For now, just create a simple starting point for the character. Go to `Marker > Player Start`, and place the start marker at a point on the map where you want the player to start.

That is it, the game is now ready. Click on the test level button to run the game. You can alternatively build the game. There several advanced options available. The more time you spend with a game, the better it gets. Once you test the level, you are bound to run into some bugs.

This is a dead end that was not intended to be there. There will also be gaps in walls, staircases that don't go anywhere, a mismatch in the levels, and a number of other problems. The




**Dead end**

real part in making the game comes now, where you have to make the gameplay and level designs better over repeated tests. The positioning of the ammunition, whether the items supplied are enough, are the waypoints laid out well. These are just some of the considerations. If you upgrade to the full version, you can build stand alone games, and even sell them.


**Kill people**

## Part II: Using Game Maker 7

Game Maker 7 is the game creator of choice for many hobbyists. You can make old school games similiar to Pacman, Mario or Galacta. The software is very versatile, and can easily handle platformers and top-down shooters. The latest version also allows you to create simple 3D games such as *Doom*. While the games made in Game Maker don't look all that great, it's a great starting point for serious enthusiasts or those who want to get into the profession. This is because the logic of games, and the gameplay itself is focused on more than the look and feel.

It is possible to create pretty versatile games in Game Maker, even a game that switches from being a platformer to